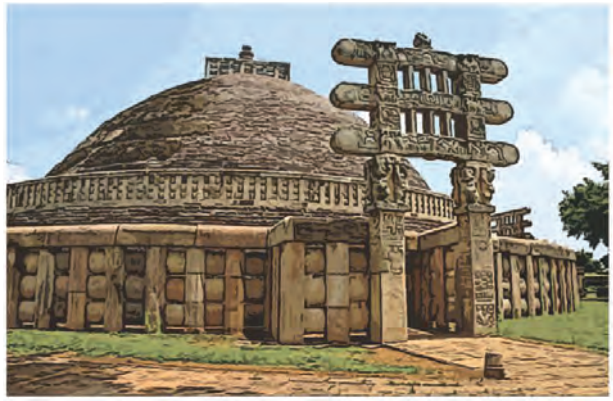
Kanchi : During the reign of the Pallava dynasty (sixth century CE), Kanchi in Tamil Nadu, emerged as an important centre of education. It was a centre for the teaching and learning of Vedic, Jain and Buddhist texts.

10.5 Art and architecture

Indian architecture reached its peak during the Maurya and the Gupta periods. The stone pillars erected by Emperor Ashoka at various places are excellent examples of Indian sculpture. The *stupa* at Sanchi and cave sculptures at Udayagiri, Khandagiri, Karla, Nashik, Ajanta, Ellora, etc. show that the same tradition advanced even further. The art of making images was developed during the Gupta period. Temple architecture developed during the reigns of the Chalukya and Pallava dynasties in South India. The temples of Mahabalipuram are a testimony to this architecture. The art of making bronze images of deities emerged during the period of the Pallavas. The iron pillar at Mehrauli near Delhi is evidence of the advanced knowledge of metallurgy of the ancient Indians.



The *stupa* at Sanchi

Thus, it is clear that ancient Indian culture was very prosperous and advanced. In the next chapter, we will study India's contact with other civilisations and its far-reaching impact.

Bronze statue of Natraj

The iron pillar at Mehrauli

Exercise

1. Answer in one sentence.

(1) Make a list of ancient Indian universities.

(2) Make a list of the Indian goods that were in demand in foreign countries.

2. Name the following.

Epics and poetic compositions of ancient India.

3. Fill in the blanks.

(1) The epic Ramayana was composed by *rishi* ..... .

(2) The science of Indian medicine is called ..... .

(3) Thousands of students could live at the ..... university.

4. Answer in brief.

(1) Explain what is meant by 'Tipitaka'.

(2) What is the the message of the Bhagvad Gita ?

(3) What aspects does Ayurveda take into account ?

(4) What is meant by Sangham Literature ?

5. Discuss.

Art and architecture of the Maurya and Gupta period.

6. What would you do ?

(1) How would you obtain information about Ayurvedic medicine and use it in your day to day life ?

(2) On a trip to a historical site, your friend is writing his name on the structure.

7. Observe the picture of the *stupa* at Sanchi and obtain more information about it.

Activity :

(1) Obtain information from the elders in your family, about some special buildings in your neighbourhood.

(2) Visit some historical buildings, memorials in your neighbourhood and write a note about the history you learn from the visits there.

* * *

The caves at Nashik

11. Ancient India and the World

11.1 India and the countries of the west
11.2 India and other countries in Asia

11.1 India and the countries of the west

People of the Harappan civilisation had developed trade relations with the countries of the west. Ever since then, India has had economic and cultural exchanges with the outside world. Buddhism had spread to Afghanistan and to many countries of Central Asia. During the period of the Iranian empire, India's contact with the western world increased. The Greek historians of that period grew more curious about India. Their writings introduced India to the western world. The routes which were later used by Alexander, were opened for trade between India and the countries of the west. Under the influence of the Greek art of sculpture, a new form of art emerged in India during the Kushana period. It is called Gandhara school of art. In the Gandhar art school images of Gautam Buddha were mainly carved. As these images were mostly found in the Gandhara region of Afghanistan, the style is called the 'Gandhara style'. The facial features of the statues made in this style are similar to those of the Greek people. The early coins that were minted in India were also like Greek coins.

A sculpture in the Gandhara style on a *stupa* at Hadda in Afghanistan. (Greek costumes, amphora and musical instruments)

Around the first or second century CE, trade between India and Rome flourished. The ports in South India also had a large share in this trade. Some articles made of bronze were found in the excavations at Kolhapur. They have been made in Rome. The excavations at Arikamedu in Tamil Nadu have also brought to light many articles made in Rome. Both these places were important centres of trade between India and Rome. Many such trade centres are mentioned in the literature of those times.

A statue of Gautama Buddha in a museum in Paris – in the Gandhara Style.

A gold coin of the Roman Emperor Augustus found at Arikamedu